

~~SECRET~~UNITED STATES DEPARTMENT OF JUSTICE
FEDERAL BUREAU OF INVESTIGATION

In Reply, Please Refer to
File No.

Washington, D.C. 20535
January 5, 1965

Title PHILIP J. KLASS

b1

Character

(S)

Reference memorandum dated and captioned as
above.

All sources (except any listed below) whose identities
are concealed in referenced communication have furnished reliable
information in the past.

The second ~~confidential~~ source referred to is
an officer in the United States Coast Guard.

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DATE: 12-20-2005
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UNITED STATES GOVERNMENT

Memorandum

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TO : Mr. Moore

DATE: 2/21/75

FROM : Mr. Heim

SUBJECT: PHILIP J. KLAS
SENIOR AVIONICS EDITOR
AVIATION WEEK & SPACE TECHNOLOGY
CRITICISM OF FBI

BACKGROUND:

Date in the afternoon of 2/18/75, captioned individual telephoned the Bureau and spoke with the Editor of the FBI Law Enforcement Bulletin (LEB). In strong terms laced with sarcasm, he derided our publication of the article by Dr. J. Allen Hynek, "The UFO Mystery," in the February, 1975, issue of the LEB. Klass suggested that by publishing this article, the FBI had given its endorsement to a hoax (that UFOs are extra-terrestrial in origin) and to a fraud (Dr. J. Allen Hynek). Klass went on to state that he had investigated UFO sightings "with the thoroughness of the FBI" over a period of many years and found not one shred of evidence that any such objects as UFOs existed, let alone that they were from beyond the earth's atmosphere. He also contended that his investigations have led to several books and many articles on the topic.

Mr. Klass was politely reminded that nowhere in Dr. Hynek's article appearing in the Bulletin, or in numerous other of his writings which were examined by us, does Hynek suggest that UFOs are extra-terrestrial in origin. Additionally, it was pointed out to Klass that the term "UFO (Unidentified Flying Object)" leaves room for all manner of phenomena both real and imagined.

Furthermore, Klass was informed that the only thing the FBI endorsed in the publication of Dr. Hynek's article was its clearly stated premise that "Regardless of the source of UFOs or their legitimacy, these sightings represented a real problem for law enforcement...." to whom persons would normally first report their observations.

As to the suggestion that the author is a fraud, Klass was informed that Hynek is a widely respected scientist, recognized by all creditable professionals in his field of expertise who is affiliated with a leading university (Northwestern University). This, Klass replied: "He won't be for long!"

1 - Mr. Moore
JHC:bhm (5)

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Mr. Keim to Mr. Moore Memorandum
RE: Philip J. Klass

Klass would not elaborate on this statement, nor was he requested to do so.

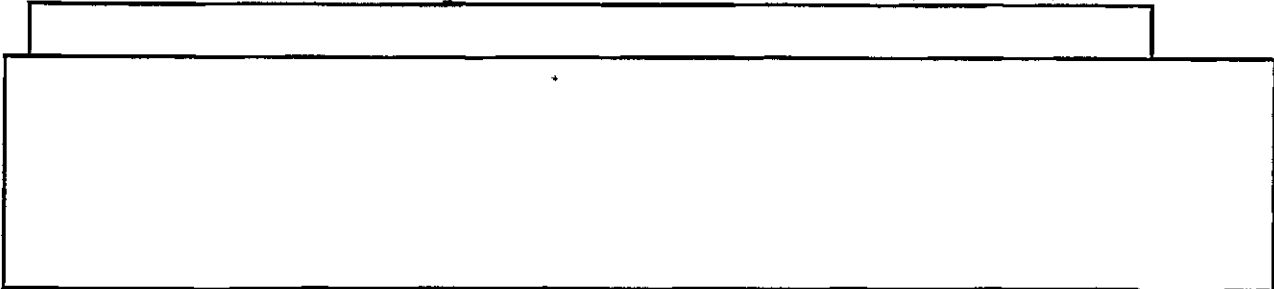
Moreover, Klass contended that Hynek's bias toward the notion that UFOs are actually objects and creatures from outer space was demonstrated following his interview of the two men from Mississippi who reported they were held captive for a time by green, other worldly beings who arrived on earth and departed from it in a saucer-shaped spaceship. Klass stated that Hynek reportedly said, "There is no doubt these men have had a terrifying experience." Mr. Klass was told that many people would draw no such inference as he had from this remark.

The conversation was concluded when Klass suggested that we might be interested in publishing an article by a newly formed organization called the "Center for Unidentified Ghosts."

INFORMATION CONCERNING KLAS:

(S) b1

Bufiles disclose that Klass has, from time to time, come to our attention by virtue of the fact that he has been in



(S) this Bureau [redacted] and
b1 not to be of assistance to his government."

Klass has been affiliated with Aviation Week & Space Technology magazine for at least the past 20 years. This periodical is published by McGraw-Hill, Inc., with offices in New York. However, Klass is based in Washington, D.C., and maintains an office in the Press Building on 14th Street, Northwest, and is listed in the D.C. telephone directory at 560 M Street, Southwest.

A book review concerning one of his published works entitled "UFOs -- Identified," published by Random House, credits him with a scientific approach to explaining the UFO phenomena, but specifically notes that he is in disagreement with Dr. Hynek and others prominent in this field.

Klass' attempts to discredit Hynek are totally without foundation. Hynek could scarcely have any better scientific cre-

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Mr. Hein to Mr. Moore Memorandum
RE: Philip J. Klass

dentials. All of his writings and public statements that were examined prior to publication of his article in the Bulletin disclose a meticulously objective and scientific view of the UFO phenomenon.

OBSERVATIONS:

In view of Klass' intemperate criticism and often irrational statements he made to support it, we should be most circumspect in any future contacts with him.

RECOMMENDATION:

For information.

A. W. G.
Chase
K

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REC-16

62-116443-2

June 23, 1975

Mr. Philip J. Klass
560 N Street, Southwest
Washington, D.C. 20024

Dear Mr. Klass:

Thank you for your letter of June 14, with enclosures, regarding the article, "The UFO Mystery," by Dr. J. Allen Hynek, which appeared in the February, 1975, issue of the FBI Law Enforcement Bulletin. The concern which prompted you to write is appreciated.

Quite contrary to the news clipping you enclosed, Dr. Hynek's article has been accurately and rationally reported by the media throughout the country. None of the responsible media, to my knowledge, have ignored the clearly stated theme of the article: "[r]egardless of the source of UFOs or their legitimacy, these sightings represented a real problem for law enforcement...." to whom persons normally first report their observations. This is the only premise the FBI has endorsed in publishing the article.

I could not agree more with your implication that law enforcement personnel should look after their primary responsibility--crime, not UFOs. This is precisely the reason we believe the Center for UFO Studies can help to free law enforcement personnel from investigating and reporting on phenomena unassociated with crime.

While we are most grateful for your offer to prepare a manuscript for publishing consideration in the Bulletin, a careful review of the magazine's commitments, regrettably, leaves us no opportunity to accept your proposal in the foreseeable future.

Sincerely yours,

Clarence M. Kelley
Director

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SEE NOTE -- OVER

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JHG:dmr (5)

MAIL ROOM ☐ TELETYPE UNIT ☐

Mr. Philip J. Klass

NOTE: Klass is well known to us. Shortly after publication of Dr. Hynek's article, he telephoned the Bulletin's editor (See Heim to Moore memorandum dated 2/21/75, re "Philip J. Klass, Senior Avionics Editor, Aviation Week & Space Technology, Criticism of FBI") and in scornful terms similar to his letter derided our publication of Hynek's article. He suggested that the FBI had been drawn into a hoax perpetrated by a fraud (Dr. Hynek). Klass is deficient on all points of his argument, particularly concerning the credentials of Dr. Hynek which could scarcely be better. Hynek has been associated professorially with some of the finest universities in this country and is recognized in the most prestigious scientific circles. On the otherhand, Klass has no such sterling reputation and has twice been under FBI investigation in connection with the unauthorized publication of classified information. Both of these cases are closed. "The National Tattler," a clipping from which Klass enclosed, is a tabloid which, until recently, specialized in bawdy sex stories but now deals in sensationalism manufactured by grossly distorting stories associated with prominent persons and agencies.

PHILIP J. KLASS
560 "N" STREET, S. W.
WASHINGTON, D. C. 20024

June 14, 1975

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Director Sec'y	

Mr. Clarence Kelly, Director
Federal Bureau of Investigation
Washington D.C.

Dear Mr. Kelly:

The enclosed photo-copy of a headline and feature story in a recent issue of the tabloid "The National Tattler" is a portent of the sort of "FBI endorsement" for the flying-saucer myth that you can expect to see, repeatedly, as a result of the article on UFOs carried by the February issue of The Law Enforcement Bulletin.

That article was written by Dr. J. Allen Hynek, the spiritual leader of the vocal group of "believers" and "kooks" who claim that we are being visited by extraterrestrial spaceships. While the FBI did not endorse Hynek's views per se, the decision to publish his article and to alert law enforcement agencies as to what to do "if they land," has enbroiled the agency for all time.

For a quarter-century, the U.S. Air Force had this monkey on its back and wisely, in 1969, bowed out of the UFO business. Now, according to the enclosed article, the FBI's decision to publish the Hynek article represents the first time that "an agency of the federal government admits that UFOs are worthy of concern."

The Hynek article published by the FBI encourages law enforcement officers to take the time--from much more pressing duties--to take calls from people who report seeing UFOs and to in turn relay such calls to Hynek's own UFO group.

Surely in these times law enforcement officers have more useful things to occupy their time and attention.

For the past 10 years, my hobby has been investigating, and explaining, famous UFO cases that Hynek and others proclaim to be unexplainable. Recently, I have published a book entitled "UFOs Explained," which has received very favorable reviews from such prestigious publications as "Scientific American." (See enclosure.)

I would welcome the opportunity to present the other side of the UFO issue in The Law Enforcement Bulletin, and to thereby help remove the earlier seeming FBI endorsement of flying saucers.

Cordially,

Philip J. Klass

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RESEARCH SECTION

EXP. PROC.

JUN 17 1975